

SIDEBAR

Mullin's Perfect Card Rewrites History

A first visit to Portugal produces a level-par round from David Mullin and top-three all-time finishes for Jon Baker and Stuart Neumann besides.

Boavista Golf & Spa Resort made its tournament debut and immediately gave up one of the great opening rounds in TEG history. David Mullin shot a flawless +0. The gross was 91, twenty over par, and it stands as the best round ever recorded in TEG. It is also the best gross round. He did not even have the decency to do it alone.

Jon Baker carded +4, the second-best round in TEG history. His gross 103 ranks third-best ever played. Stuart Neumann trailed him on both counts without disgracing

himself: +11, the third-best round of all time, and a gross 100 that sits second on the all-time gross list.

Three players. Three top-three all-time performances. One course, one afternoon. The field score was five, which meant the day's spread was enormous, running from Mullin's perfect card down to a worst score of 0. The headline, though, was written on the first visit to Lagos. Boavista had produced history.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY David MULLIN (+0)
TROPHY LEAD David MULLIN, 4 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD David MULLIN, 9 ahead

ROUND NET VP
DM 0 JB +4 SN +11 GW +12 HM +24
ROUND GROSS
DM +20 SN +29 JB +32 GW +40 HM +42

AFTER R1 • TROPHY
DM 0 JB +4 SN +11 GW +12 HM +24
AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET
DM +20 SN +29 JB +32 GW +40 HM +42

SIDEBAR

A Tight Top, a Lonely Bottom

Four lead changes settle nothing for long at the top of the Trophy race, but Henry Meller's day puts him in a different sort of race entirely.

The Trophy lead changed hands four times across the front nine at Boavista. This was opening jockeying rather than drama. Williams drew level with his birdie at the par-3 2nd. Jon Baker took the outright lead at the 4th, and did so while making a bogey. Mullin pulled level with a bogey of his own at the par-4 5th. Baker shared the lead again with

a par at the par-5 8th. Then Mullin's finish settled the matter and carried him to the outright TEG 1 Trophy lead.

At the other end, Henry Meller was already beyond assistance. A double bogey at the par-5 3rd dropped him to the bottom of the TEG 1 Wooden Spoon race, and he treated the position as

permanent. From the 11th to the 15th he bled 20 shots, including a quintuple bogey at the 14th and a quadruple bogey at the 15th, Boavista's hardest hole. That last one is almost respectable. The rest were not. By the close of play he stood alone at the foot of the Spoon table, unbothered, unchallenged, and entirely responsible.

GREGG WILLIAMS

Level at Two, Lost by Eighteen

A share of the lead through two holes gives no hint of the 22 shots Gregg Williams is about to concede over the closing stretch.

Gregg Williams began TEG 1's opening round at Boavista as a man of substance. He birdied the par-3 2nd to draw level for the outright lead in the Green Jacket (Gross) standings. He then parred the 3rd, dropping nothing across the pair. It was as good as his day would get.

From the 12th, the structure gave way. Double bogeys at the 12th, 13th and 15th. A sextuple bogey 9 at the par-3 14th, his worst hole against par all round. A quintuple bogey 9 at the 17th. A final double bogey at the last, delivered with the air of a man completing paperwork. Across seven holes, the 12th to the 18th, he shed 22 shots.

The mitigation is thin. Only the double at the 15th came on a genuinely hard hole, the par-4 1st stroke index. The rest arrived on the easier holes, which were offering no resistance whatsoever. He began the round sharing the lead. He finished it rooted to the bottom of the field.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 2, Round 1

RARE FEATS

- Gregg Williams runs up a 9 (+6) at the 14th — his career-worst on a par-3
- Stuart Neumann runs up an 8 (+5) at the 14th — his career-worst on a par-3